

6.6

Using notes to write a report

Worksheet

- 1 Choose one of the topics below.
- 2 Study the notes carefully. They are not in any special order.
- 3 Decide how to organize the information to make a report.
- 4 Expand the ideas to write a short report. You are free to add your own ideas as well.

- 1 You are the Human Resources Director of a retail bank which needs to cut a large number of jobs. Your report will be called Progress report on future layoffs.
 - Management has promised no compulsory layoffs and has offered attractive packages for staff leaving voluntarily: pension protection, cash payments, retraining.
 - Background: 1) strong competition; 2) customers prefer telephone and on-line services. Our response to the problem: concentrate operations at a few Operation Centers (O.C.s).
 - Union wants management to maintain a register of former staff. People from this register would be contacted first to fill temporary posts. This is unacceptable to management.
 - We will need to close 350 branches over the next five years. 10,000 layoffs will be needed (quarter of workforce).
 - No agreement with Union on size of retraining budget. Union wants \$6000 per employee. We have offered \$4000.
 - Staff morale very low in present situation. Should improve in long term – when the new O.C.s start working.
 - How much control do we have over retraining? Will leavers be free to go anywhere on any course? Some of the retraining could be done in-company at cheaper cost. Investigate and prepare report for next meeting.
- 2 You write a column for a financial newsletter that reports on investment opportunities. Finosa is an imaginary French pharmaceuticals company. Your report will be called Finosa shares – a good time to buy?
 - Finosa has a new drug to treat narrowed arteries, called Vipax. At a recent presentation, Mr. Gerard Haberer, research and development director at Finosa said *'For us Vipax is a very important product. We expect to find a very big market for this product.'*
 - 53% of Finosa's shares are owned by the Bergamot cosmetics group. Four weeks ago Bergamot announced that they want to sell some of these shares. Since then, Finosa's share price has climbed from 70 euros to 84 euros.
 - The pharmaceuticals industry has been going through a period of consolidation, with a lot of mergers and acquisitions.
 - Mr. Phillipe Cottet, a pharmaceuticals analyst in Paris, wrote last week *'The price of Finosa shares already includes the profit potential of their new products. Finosa are making very optimistic sales forecasts.'*
 - Finosa is the world's 12th. largest pharmaceuticals company in terms of sales.
 - The medical journal 'The Doctor' said *'The benefits of using Vipax are exaggerated. The high cost of Vipax in comparison with existing treatments such as aspirin will restrict its sales.'*
 - The Paris stock exchange is full of rumors that another French drugs group, Labsynth, is interested in forming some sort of merger with Finosa. Labsynth have denied these rumours.

